Data availability

Chemical

pH (1:5)
Macronutrients (N,Ca, P)
Carbonates (% CO_3)
Field capacity
Heavy metals

Biological

Organic Matter (%)
C/N Ratio
Organic carbon (%)

Physical

Clays (%)
Silts (%)
Sands (%)
Texture

Risks

The first is price volatility/premium fatigue if demand softens; this is mitigated by diversifying buyers and by anchoring the claim in recognised standards rather than in a single buyer's programme. The second is practice persistence under drought pressure; the agronomic design therefore includes drought-tolerant mixes and operational guidance for dry years. The third barrier lies in excessive bureaucracy. The solution here is : shorter contracts, minimal paperwork, and digital records wherever possible.



Preliminary results

Lessons learned are simple: (i) price matters most, set the per-hectare compensation at a level that truly covers costs and risk; (ii) keep contracts short, flexible and low-bureaucracy; (iii) pair practice-based proof with a minimal soil-indicator set to sustain credible claims; and (iv) use small public seed funding to overcome initial fixed costs, then let the value chain carry the incentive thereafter.

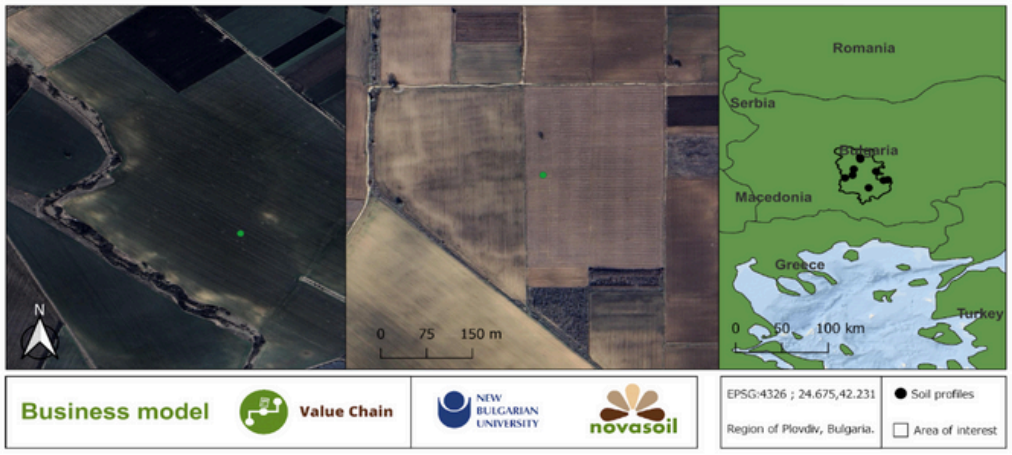
Economic perspective

Revenue stems from a mix of premia and volume. First, a quality/heritage premium for bottles carrying the stewardship claim and local label; second, higher margin direct sales linked to tourism; third, where appropriate, modest public top-ups (e.g., eco-scheme style supports) to de-risk adoption in the first two seasons. The DCE confirms that the per-hectare payment is the main accelerator of adoption; in practice, this may be delivered by a buyer premium on contracted hectares, potentially blended with a small public contribution to cover initial costs of certification and monitoring. In time, as practices normalise and monitoring costs fall, the public component can taper.

Policy and governance

The case leverages Bulgaria's experience with quality schemes and the institutional scaffolding around the wine sector, but it recognises that trust is earned through clarity and ease, not merely through regulation. Contracts should be short to medium term, with renewal options and minimal administrative burden. A neutral intermediary (cooperative, producer group or a recognised regional body) can reduce transaction costs, organise basic monitoring, and interface with buyers. Public agencies still matter: their role is to co-finance early fixed costs (e.g., advisory time, initial monitoring protocol, label registration) and to provide light-touch oversight so that claims remain credible without becoming onerous.

Organic vineyards in integrated production



novasoil

The NOVASOIL project aims to show the benefits for society and the environment of investing in soil health.

The main output of the project will be a tool to analyse the suitability of different business cases that promote soil health.

This tool will be based on best practice examples in Europe and other countries, as well as on the needs and demands of society.

Integrated production in the vineyards with vinery and rural tourism

Summarize



The aim of the Case Study in the Plovdiv region is to value the potential of local and regional traditional products in the wine sector and strengthen their relationship with communities in order to develop the local economy and agricultural sector.

The effective functioning of the wine sector in recent years leads to the improvement and stabilization of the sector as a whole, increasing the quality and competitiveness of Bulgarian wines, both in the domestic and foreign markets.

The Plovdiv region case study will focus on investigating experience in the project by focusing on different interventions for reducing soil erosion, increasing productivity, and based on landscape alliance and cooperation with other local tourism to reach added value to the agronomic management.



Figure 1. Structure of the NOVASOIL project

Objectives

The objective is to investigate the local and regional traditional products through certification and production standards giving additional opportunities to touch with the culture and traditions of the local economy and communities. As a result, new business models can be defined, aiming to manage soil health and add value to the wine supply chain.

Case studies properties

Potential inhibitors

The Regional Vine and Wine Chamber (RVWC) "Trakia" – Plovdiv , Agricultural and Credit Cooperative "Solidarnost" – Plovdiv, Vineyard and wine cooperative cellar, Brestovitsa, Plovdiv region, Agricultural University – Plovdiv, Regional administration, Farmer association

Potential enablers

Economic crisis, Climate Change, competition with products from other countries with a lower cost

Potential stakeholders

Social awareness (interested in high quality and healthy product)
Existing supply chain network and policies programs/measures



Specific objectives

SO1 Multi-dimensional portfolio development of business cases and good examples for investing in soil health in Europe and beyond.

SO2 Analysis of current models around the world for creating new incentives and new revenues from healthy soils.

SO3 Apply a co-development approach to modelling that promotes soil health.

SO4 Develop a prototype incentive toolbox and test network.

SO5 Analysis of current policies and technologies related to soil health and income provision for farmers.

SO6 Developing a community of practice around investors and key soil health actors.

SO7 Increase interest in soil health through a digital marketing strategy plan

Funded by the European Union. Grant agreement ID: 101091268

novasoil

INNOVATIVE BUSINESS MODELS FOR SOIL HEALTH

https://novasoil-project.eu

